In the oceans, phytoplankton, a vital food source that also relied on photosynthesis, died out. Creatures that fed on phytoplankton then faced extinction. These included cephalopods, such as belemnites and ammonites, and the marine reptiles known as the mosasaurs and the sauropterygians.



Although many flying dinosaurs survived the K-Pg mass extinction at the end of the Cretaceous period, all pterosaurs perished, ending their 162-million-year stay on Earth.